

USA MISSIONARIES

God Designed Us to Gather

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Hebrews 10:24-25** “Do not give up meeting together... but encourage one another.”
- **Acts 2:42** “They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and to fellowship...”
- **Psalms 122:1** “I rejoiced with those who said to me, ‘Let us go to the house of the Lord.’”

KEY IDEA

- Church is not a building.
- It is the gathering of believers.
- From the beginning, God formed a people, not isolated individuals.
- The early church met consistently for teaching, fellowship, prayer, and breaking of bread.
- Weekly gathering is not religious routine.
- It is spiritual alignment.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Why do you think Scripture emphasizes meeting together?
2. What happens spiritually when gathering becomes optional?
3. Do you see church as essential or convenient?

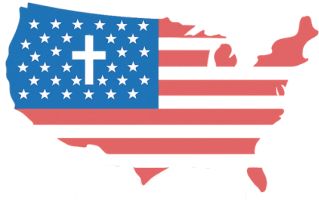
We Gather to Worship and Be Formed

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Colossians 3:16** “Let the word of Christ dwell among you richly as you teach and admonish one another...”
- **Ephesians 5:19** “Speak to one another with psalms, hymns, and songs from the Spirit...”
- **Acts 20:7** “On the first day of the week we came together to break bread.”

KEY IDEA

- Corporate worship shapes the heart.
- Hearing the Word strengthens faith.
- Singing truth renews the mind.
- You cannot disciple yourself alone.
- We are formed in community.



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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. How does corporate worship affect your heart differently than private worship?
2. What role does preaching play in spiritual growth?
3. Where are you being sharpened by other believers?

We Gather for Encouragement and Accountability

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Proverbs 27:17** “As iron sharpens iron...”
- **James 5:16** “Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other...”
- **1 Corinthians 12:27** “Now you are the body of Christ...”

KEY IDEA

- Isolation weakens faith.
- Community strengthens it.
- The Church is described as a body.
- Each member needs the others.
- Weekly gathering provides:
 - Encouragement
 - Correction
 - Prayer support
 - Spiritual accountability

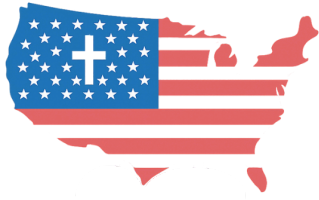
DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Who is speaking into your life regularly?
2. Are you known by other believers?
3. What happens when believers drift from community?

We Gather Because Jesus Is Present

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Matthew 18:20** “Where two or three gather in My name, there am I with them.”
- **Revelation 1:12-13** Jesus walking among the lampstands.



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KEY IDEA

- When believers gather in His name, Jesus is present among them.
- Church is not about preference or style.
- It is about meeting with the living Christ together.
- Weekly gathering keeps Christ at the center of our lives.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Do you come expecting to encounter Jesus?
2. What distractions pull your focus away from worship?
3. How would your mindset change if you viewed church as meeting with Christ?

Church Is Not Optional for the Disciple

KEY SCRIPTURES

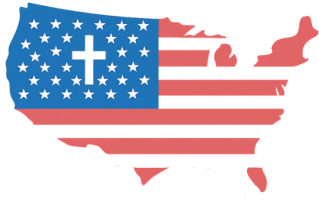
- **Hebrews 3:13** “Encourage one another daily... so that none of you may be hardened by sin.”
- **Ephesians 4:11-12** Leaders are given “to equip His people for works of service.”

KEY IDEA

- Spiritual growth requires structure.
- God gives pastors and teachers to equip believers.
- Skipping gathering consistently leads to spiritual drift.
- Weekly church attendance is obedience, not preference.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Is church attendance shaped by conviction or convenience?
2. What patterns are forming in your family through your example?
3. Are you fully planted in a local body?



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Heart Check

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Matthew 6:33** “Seek first the kingdom...”
- **Psalms 92:13** “Planted in the house of the Lord, they will flourish...”

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. What competes with church in my weekly priorities?
2. Do I arrange my schedule around worship or fit worship into my schedule?
3. Am I flourishing spiritually?

Practical Church Commitment Plan

- Commit to weekly gathering.
- Arrive prepared and expectant
- Engage in worship fully.
- Serve in a ministry area.
- Build relationships beyond Sunday.
- Protect the day from competing distractions.

PERSONAL ACTION QUESTIONS

1. Am I consistently attending a local church?
2. What needs to change in my schedule?
3. Where can I serve and contribute?
4. Who can I invite to attend with me?

Closing Prayer Prompt

Lord, plant me deeply in Your Church. Guard my heart from isolation and drift. Help me value gathering with Your people. Use me to encourage others as we worship You together. Amen.